



Now comes Ubuntu Desktop Support Services, from Canonical

Canonical's Desktop Support Services include three offerings: Starter, Advanced and Professional. The Starter Desktop Service provides support for installation, setting up and basic functionalities such as Internet, creating documents and playing music and videos. The Advanced Desktop Service is for more experienced users who need help migrating files and settings from a previously used operating system, or need assistance with desktop publishing and personal accounting. The Professional Desktop Service is for business users who have Ubuntu as their



main environment. Installation support ensures that the Ubuntu machine is set up on the corporate network and integrated into existing IT services.

Red Hat extends its partner ecosystem

Red Hat has launched the enhanced Partner Program initiative. The Red Hat Partner Program will now include a Premier Business Partner level, in addition to Advanced and Ready classifications. The program will also feature infrastructure, middleware and virtualisation specialisations. Additionally, the redesigned program is intended to enable Red Hat's partner community to collaborate and innovate to create complete solutions that solve customers' IT challenges.

Google Wave is now open source

Internet search giant Google has open sourced two components of its new-age communications platform, Google Wave. Launched in May this year, Google Wave is a Web platform that combines e-mail, instant messaging, social networking and document collaboration.

The two components that have been open sourced are Operational Transform (OT) code along with the underlying wave model, and the client/server application prototype to drive the interest of third-party developers. The company is promoting developer interest for implementations and hence making it easier for users and businesses to customise applications.

All of this — nearly 40,000 lines of Java code — is available under the Apache 2.0 licence. Google has also announced that the protocol specification, white papers and API documentation are being made available under a Creative Commons attribution licence.



tr.im URL shortening service opens up

The trim URL shortening service, currently run by Nambu, is to become a community-based service and the source code to the URL shortener is to be released under an MIT licence. The plan is that by September 15th, Eric Woodward, president, Nambu, will donate the trim domain to the community, release the source code as open source and offer link-map data to all. Woodward will also personally guarantee shortfalls in the new trim's operating expenses, 'indefinitely'. trim will then accept donations to help meet those expenses and, to aid transparency, all statistics on usage, operating cash flow, redirects and creation counts, will be published.

VMWare buys SpringSource for \$420m

VMWare has acquired SpringSource for \$420 million in a deal that includes the developers of the Spring framework for Java applications, application server technology, the Groovy and Grails experts from G2One and the Hyperic management tools that SpringSource acquired in May. VMWare intends to use the SpringSource technology to create a fully integrated 'Platform as a Service' (PaaS) solution, combining VMWare virtualisation and management with a complete Java stack, from servers to frameworks and languages, with the Hyperic management tools integrated into the platform as a first class citizen.

Mono releases beta of Moonlight 2.0

Following a series of preview versions, the Mono Project has now released a beta of Moonlight version 2.0, the free Silverlight implementation. The software, which is available to download as a Firefox plug-in, allows WMA files and multimedia content implemented using Microsoft's Silverlight, to be played under Linux. Streaming is said to be substantially improved under Moonlight 2.0.

This version is mostly licensed under the GNU LGPL 2, except for the Microsoft Silverlight Controls and Unit Test Framework, which is under the MS-PL licence, and some managed code and tools that are under an MIT licence.

